

Illinois

Everything is extraordinary in Illinois! Remarkable buildings in Chicago give it a special place in world history. President Abraham Lincoln, who accomplished monumental changes as the country's leader, called Illinois home. Even the Chicago River does mind-boggling feats!

State Facts

Abbreviation: IL

Capital: Springfield

Nickname: Land of Lincoln

Statehood: 1818, 21st state

Population: 12.8 million people

State animal: white-tailed deer

State bird: northern cardinal



Reach for the sky

Chicago, Illinois, was the birthplace of the skyscraper. The first skyscrapers in Chicago were built after a lot of the city was destroyed in a terrible fire in 1871.

At the time, people were amazed at the new 10-story buildings. Today, skyscrapers can be over 100 stories tall!



Pumpkins are a top crop in Illinois. The ones grown here are often used for pie fillings.

